

MARBLE EFFECTS LAB

30+ Marble & Stone Effect *Recipes*

Step-by-step instructions for realistic marble and
stone wall finishes. Every material, every step,
every technique.

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Introduction

Welcome to the most complete collection of marble and stone wall effect recipes available. This guide is designed to take you from zero experience to confidently executing premium marble finishes that clients will pay top dollar for.

How to Use This Guide

Each recipe in this guide follows a consistent format:

- **Difficulty Level** — Easy, Medium, or Advanced, so you know what to expect.
- **Time Estimate** — How long each step takes, including drying time.
- **Materials List** — Every product and tool you need, with exact quantities for one standard wall (approx. 3m x 2.5m / 10ft x 8ft).
- **Step-by-Step Instructions** — Clear, numbered steps with visual cues so you know exactly when to move to the next step.
- **Pro Tips** — Insider techniques that separate beginners from professionals.

Before You Start

Regardless of which effect you choose, every wall needs proper preparation:

Clean the surface — Remove dust, grease, and loose paint with a damp cloth and degreaser.

Fill imperfections — Use wall filler on cracks and holes. Sand smooth once dry.

Apply primer — Use an acrylic bonding primer. Let dry completely (2-4 hours).

Apply base coat — Each recipe specifies its base coat color. Apply two coats with a roller, letting each dry fully.

Practice on a sample board (MDF or plywood, 60×60cm minimum) before working on the actual wall. This lets you calibrate your technique and adjust colors without risk.

Essential Tools

These tools appear across most recipes. Have them ready before starting any effect:

- Stainless steel spatula (flexible, 8-10cm blade)
- Wide stainless steel trowel (20-25cm)
- Mixing palette or flat surface
- Acrylic putty / decorative stucco (white base)
- Universal pigments (black, raw umber, burnt sienna, yellow ochre, white — adjust per recipe)
- Fine sandpaper (320-400 grit)
- Painter's tape

- Lint-free cloths
- Spray bottle with water
- Clear sealer / wax (matte or satin finish)

Carrara White

01

Easy

1.5-2 hours active

Classic Italian marble

The most iconic marble in the world — soft white background with delicate grey veining. Perfect for bathrooms, feature walls, and fireplaces. This is the ideal first recipe for beginners.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 2 kg

Black pigment — 5 ml

Raw umber pigment — 3 ml

White base paint — 500 ml

Fine sandpaper 400 grit

Clear matte sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of pure white base paint with a roller. Let each coat dry completely (2 hours minimum).
2. Mix white acrylic putty with a tiny amount of black and raw umber pigment to create a very light warm grey. The mixture should barely look tinted — Carrara veins are subtle.
3. Load a small amount of the tinted putty onto the edge of your spatula. Hold it at a 15-20 degree angle to the wall.
4. Create veins by dragging the spatula diagonally across the surface in long, flowing movements. Carrara veins flow primarily in one direction — choose your direction and commit.
5. Vary the pressure: lighter pressure creates thinner veins, heavier pressure creates broader, softer ones. Leave generous white space between veins.
6. Using a clean, dry spatula, lightly burnish (smooth over) the veined areas to blend the edges. Work in the same diagonal direction.
7. Add one or two secondary veins that branch off the main veins at slight angles. These should be thinner and lighter.
8. Let dry completely — 6 to 8 hours minimum.
9. Sand very lightly with 400 grit sandpaper using circular motions. Wipe dust with a damp cloth.
0. Apply clear matte sealer in thin, even coats. Two coats recommended, 2 hours between coats.

Pro Tip: Study a photo of real Carrara marble on your phone while working. Veins in real Carrara are irregular — avoid making them too straight or evenly spaced. One bold vein with two or three lighter companions is the natural pattern.

Drying time: 12-24 hours total before use

Calacatta Gold

02

Medium

2-2.5 hours active

Premium Italian marble

Calacatta is the most luxurious marble — bright white base with bold, dramatic veining in warm gold and grey tones. Rarer and more expensive than Carrara in real stone, this effect commands premium pricing from clients.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg	Yellow ochre pigment — 8 ml
Raw umber pigment — 5 ml	Black pigment — 3 ml
Burnt sienna pigment — 3 ml	White base paint — 500 ml
Fine sandpaper 400 grit	Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of pure white base paint. Dry 2+ hours per coat.
2. Prepare two vein mixtures: (A) white putty + yellow ochre + a touch of burnt sienna for the golden veins; (B) white putty + black + raw umber for the grey veins.
3. Start with the golden mixture (A). Apply bold diagonal veins using the spatula edge — Calacatta veins are thicker and more dramatic than Carrara.
4. While the golden veins are still wet, add grey veins (B) alongside and partially overlapping them. This creates the characteristic warm-meets-cool depth.
5. Use a clean spatula to lightly blend where the two colors meet, but leave areas where the gold transitions sharply to grey — this natural variation is key.
6. Add fine secondary veins radiating from the main structure using just the corner of your spatula.
7. Burnish the entire surface with long, smooth passes of a clean wide trowel.
8. Dry 8 hours minimum.
9. Sand lightly with 400 grit. Wipe clean.
10. Apply satin sealer — two coats. The satin sheen enhances the golden warmth.

Pro Tip: Calacatta's wow factor comes from contrast. Don't be afraid of bold veins — this isn't Carrara. The white space between veins should be pure and clean, making the gold-grey veins pop.

Drying time: 12-24 hours total

Emperador Dark

03

Medium

2-3 hours active

Rich dark Spanish marble

A deep, warm brown marble with intricate lighter veining. Emperador creates a dramatic, sophisticated look perfect for accent walls, bars, and luxury spaces.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg

Burnt umber pigment — 20 ml

Raw umber pigment — 10 ml

Black pigment — 8 ml

Yellow ochre pigment — 5 ml

White pigment — 10 ml

Dark brown base paint — 500 ml

Fine sandpaper 320 grit

Satin sealer — 250 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of dark chocolate brown base paint. Dry 2+ hours per coat.
2. Mix the main body color: white putty + burnt umber + raw umber + a little black. Should be a rich espresso brown.
3. Apply a thin, textured layer of the brown mixture over the entire wall using the wide trowel. Leave subtle texture — not perfectly smooth.
4. Prepare vein mixture: white putty + yellow ochre + a touch of white pigment for warm cream-colored veins.
5. Create a web-like network of veins — Emperador has more frequent, shorter veins compared to Carrara. They branch and reconnect.
6. Add some thinner veins using just white putty for brighter highlights.
7. While still slightly damp, use a clean spatula to gently blend and soften the vein edges.
8. Add depth by applying a very thin transparent layer of the dark mixture over some areas, partially obscuring some veins.
9. Dry 8+ hours. Sand lightly with 320 grit.
10. Apply satin sealer — two coats. The satin finish deepens the brown tones beautifully.

Pro Tip: The key to Emperador is depth. Build layers: dark base → brown texture → light veins → selective dark glaze. Each layer should be visible in the final result.

Drying time: 16-24 hours total

Medium

2 hours active

Black Spanish marble

Striking black marble with bold white veining from the Basque region of Spain. One of the most dramatic and modern-looking marble effects.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 2 kg

Black pigment — 25 ml

White pigment — 15 ml

Raw umber pigment — 3 ml

Black base paint — 500 ml

Fine sandpaper 400 grit

Gloss sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of pure black base paint. Dry 2+ hours per coat.
2. Mix white putty with white pigment to create a bright, opaque white vein mixture.
3. Also prepare a subtle grey: white putty + small amount of black + touch of raw umber.
4. Apply bold white veins diagonally. Nero Marquina veins are confident and dramatic — not delicate.
5. Add the grey mixture alongside the white veins to create shadow and depth.
6. Some veins should be thick and bold, others thin and wispy. The contrast is what makes this marble striking.
7. Burnish lightly to integrate the veins into the surface without losing their definition.
8. Dry 8+ hours. Sand gently with 400 grit.
9. Apply gloss sealer — this effect looks best with a high-shine finish. Two coats, 2 hours apart.

Pro Tip: The black base must be completely opaque. If you can see the wall color through it, add a third coat. White veins on a patchy black base look amateurish.

Drying time: 12-24 hours total

Statuario Veined

05

Advanced

2.5-3 hours active

Italian luxury marble

The marble of Michelangelo. Pure white with bold grey veins and occasional warm undertones. Statuario is considered the most prestigious marble — the perfect upsell for high-end clients.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 3 kg

Black pigment — 8 ml

Raw umber pigment — 4 ml

Yellow ochre pigment — 2 ml

White base paint — 600 ml

Fine sandpaper 400 grit

Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of brilliant white base. This must be the purest white you can get — no warm tints.
2. Prepare main vein mix: white putty + black + touch of raw umber for medium grey veins.
3. Prepare highlight mix: white putty + yellow ochre for subtle warm accent veins.
4. Begin with bold, sweeping diagonal veins using the grey mixture. Statuario veins are fewer but larger than Carrara — think broad brushstrokes.
5. Layer: add darker areas within the veins by adding more black pigment to your mixture and applying it within the existing wet veins.
6. Add faint warm veins using the ochre mixture in areas between the grey veins.
7. Burnish the entire surface in long diagonal passes, compressing the material and creating a polished look.
8. Dry 6-8 hours. Sand with 400 grit. Wipe clean.
9. Apply satin sealer — two thin coats.

Pro Tip: Statuario's veins have visible internal gradient — darker at the center, lighter at the edges. Achieve this by varying the pigment concentration within a single stroke.

Drying time: 14-24 hours total

Travertine Classic

06

Easy

1.5-2 hours active

Natural stone texture

A warm, earthy stone finish with natural pitting and horizontal banding. Travertine is one of the easiest effects to execute and always looks impressive.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 3 kg

Yellow ochre pigment — 15 ml

Raw umber pigment — 8 ml

Burnt sienna pigment — 5 ml

Warm beige base paint — 500 ml

Sandpaper 320 grit

Matte sealer — 250 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of warm beige base paint. Dry 2+ hours per coat.
2. Mix two shades: (A) putty + yellow ochre + raw umber for a warm tan; (B) putty + burnt sienna + raw umber for a deeper brown.
3. Apply mixture A in random patches using the wide trowel, leaving some areas untouched. Work horizontally — travertine has horizontal banding.
4. While wet, apply mixture B in smaller patches within and alongside the first layer.
5. Here is the travertine trick: lightly skip the trowel over the surface, creating natural-looking pits and voids. Don't fill every gap.
6. Let this layer dry partially (30-45 minutes, still slightly tacky).
7. Apply a thin topcoat using mixture A, skimming over the surface. This fills some pits but leaves others open, creating the characteristic depth.
8. Burnish lightly with a clean trowel to polish the high points.
9. Dry 8+ hours. Sand very lightly.
0. Apply matte sealer — travertine looks most natural with a matte finish.

Pro Tip: The pits are what make travertine look real. Resist the urge to fill all of them. A surface that's too smooth will just look like a painted wall.

Drying time: 12-24 hours total

Advanced

3-4 hours active

Translucent warm stone

A stunning warm amber stone with translucent-looking layers and flowing patterns. Honey Onyx is an advanced technique that produces a breathtaking backlit-looking effect.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 3 kg

Yellow ochre pigment — 20 ml

Burnt sienna pigment — 10 ml

Raw umber pigment — 5 ml

White pigment — 10 ml

Warm gold base paint — 500 ml

Sandpaper 400 grit

Gloss sealer — 250 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of warm gold/honey base paint.
2. Mix three separate batches: (A) light honey — putty + yellow ochre + white; (B) amber — putty + yellow ochre + burnt sienna; (C) dark caramel — putty + burnt sienna + raw umber.
3. Apply all three in flowing, organic swirls across the surface. Each color should blend into the next without hard edges.
4. Use a spray bottle to lightly mist the surface, then drag the wide trowel through the wet material to create flowing, water-like patterns.
5. Add white highlights by applying small dabs of putty + white pigment in lighter areas. Blend softly.
6. The illusion of translucency comes from layering: let this first layer dry (4 hours), then apply a very thin second pass using mostly the light honey mixture (A), allowing the darker layers beneath to show through.
7. Burnish firmly with a wide trowel to develop a polished, glowing surface.
8. Dry 8+ hours. Sand with 400 grit.
9. Apply gloss sealer — onyx must shine. Two to three coats for maximum depth.

Pro Tip: Onyx's magic is in the layering. Each thin translucent layer adds depth. Rushing with one thick layer will look flat and muddy.

Drying time: 24-36 hours total

Green Onyx

08

Advanced

3-4 hours active

Exotic translucent stone

An exotic, jewel-like stone with deep emerald greens and translucent lighter areas. Green Onyx commands premium pricing and is perfect for luxury bars, spas, and statement walls.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 3 kg

Chrome green pigment — 15 ml

Yellow ochre pigment — 8 ml

Black pigment — 5 ml

White pigment — 10 ml

Forest green base paint — 500 ml

Sandpaper 400 grit

Gloss sealer — 250 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of deep forest green base paint.
2. Mix three batches: (A) light jade — putty + chrome green + white + yellow ochre; (B) emerald — putty + chrome green; (C) dark forest — putty + chrome green + black.
3. Apply in flowing organic patterns similar to Honey Onyx, but with a more crystalline, angular quality.
4. Add veins of lighter color (mix A) cutting through the darker areas.
5. Mist with water and blend using the wide trowel in sweeping curves.
6. Let dry 4 hours. Apply a thin translucent second layer focusing on the light areas to build the backlit illusion.
7. Burnish firmly for a polished look.
8. Dry 8+ hours. Sand. Apply 2-3 coats of gloss sealer.

Pro Tip: Reference real Green Onyx photos — the lighter areas look like they glow from within. Concentrate your lightest mixture in the center of these areas, getting progressively darker toward the edges.

Drying time: 24-36 hours total

Blue Sodalite

09

Advanced

3-4 hours active

Deep blue semi-precious stone

A deep, royal blue stone with white and grey inclusions. Blue Sodalite is rare and expensive in nature, making this effect particularly impressive and profitable.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 3 kg

Ultramarine blue pigment — 20 ml

Black pigment — 8 ml

White pigment — 15 ml

Raw umber pigment — 3 ml

Dark navy base paint — 500 ml

Sandpaper 400 grit

Gloss sealer — 250 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of dark navy blue base paint.
2. Mix three batches: (A) royal blue — putty + ultramarine; (B) deep blue — putty + ultramarine + black; (C) white-grey veins — putty + white + touch of raw umber.
3. Apply mixtures A and B in large, irregular patches across the surface, blending where they meet.
4. While wet, create white inclusions by pressing small amounts of mixture C into the blue surface using the spatula tip. Sodalite has angular, mineral-like white patches — not smooth veins.
5. Use a clean spatula to partially blend the white into the blue at the edges, leaving the centers bright.
6. Add thin grey lines between some of the larger patches.
7. Burnish the surface firmly, compressing all layers together.
8. Dry 8+ hours. Sand lightly. Apply 2-3 coats of gloss sealer.

Pro Tip: Sodalite's white patches are irregular and blocky, not round or flowing. Think of cracked ice frozen in deep blue water.

Drying time: 24-36 hours total

Rosa Portogallo

10

Easy

1.5-2 hours active

Warm pink Italian marble

A warm, rosy marble with soft coral and cream veining. Elegant and feminine — popular for bedrooms, powder rooms, and boutique retail spaces.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg

Red oxide pigment — 5 ml

Yellow ochre pigment — 3 ml

White pigment — 10 ml

Warm pink base paint — 500 ml

Sandpaper 400 grit

Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of warm blush pink base paint.
2. Mix veins: putty + white pigment + touch of yellow ochre for cream-colored veins.
3. Mix body color: putty + red oxide + yellow ochre for the deeper coral patches.
4. Apply the coral mixture in soft, flowing areas. Leave most of the pink base visible.
5. Add cream veins flowing through and between the coral areas.
6. Burnish gently — this marble should look soft, not sharply defined.
7. Dry 6+ hours. Sand lightly. Apply satin sealer.

Pro Tip: Keep everything soft and warm. No hard edges, no dramatic contrast. Rosa Portogallo is about gentle warmth and elegance.

Drying time: 12-24 hours total

Venetian Stucco

11

Easy

2-3 hours active

Classic polished plaster

The original Italian decorative wall finish. Not technically marble, but the foundation technique for all marble effects. Multiple thin layers of tinted plaster burnished to a high sheen.

MATERIALS

Venetian stucco / lime putty — 3 kg

Pigment of choice — 15 ml

Sandpaper 400 grit

Wax sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

1. No base paint needed — apply directly to primed wall.
2. Tint the stucco with your chosen pigment. Start with less — you can always add more.
3. Apply the first coat with the wide trowel in random, overlapping strokes. Cover the wall but leave visible texture and slight variation.
4. Dry 4 hours. Apply a second coat, slightly thinner, filling in the low spots of the first layer.
5. Dry 4 hours. Apply a third, very thin coat — this is the finishing coat. Apply it in tight, firm strokes.
6. Burnish immediately after the third coat by pressing hard with the clean trowel and polishing in circular motions. The friction generates heat that polishes the lime to a natural sheen.
7. Let cure 24 hours. Apply wax sealer with a lint-free cloth. Buff to desired sheen.

Pro Tip: The burnishing step is where the magic happens. Press hard and work fast — the surface should feel warm under the trowel. This is real traditional technique, not just decoration.

Drying time: 24-48 hours total

Easy

1.5 hours active

Industrial modern

The modern industrial aesthetic. Raw concrete walls are everywhere in contemporary design, but real concrete is cold, expensive, and impractical. This effect gives you the look with none of the downsides.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 3 kg

Black pigment — 10 ml

Raw umber pigment — 5 ml

Light grey base paint — 500 ml

Sandpaper 320 grit

Matte sealer — 250 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of light grey base paint.
2. Mix two shades of grey: (A) medium grey — putty + black + raw umber; (B) darker grey — more black pigment.
3. Apply mixture A in broad, random trowel strokes. Leave visible trowel marks and slight texture — this is concrete, not marble.
4. While wet, add patches of mixture B to create subtle variation and shadow. Blend loosely.
5. Optionally, create "formwork lines" — subtle horizontal or vertical lines where concrete panels would meet. Use the edge of your spatula to press a gentle line into the surface.
6. Dry 6+ hours. Sand with 320 grit — leave it slightly rough.
7. Apply matte sealer — never use gloss for concrete.

Pro Tip: Real concrete is imperfect. Small air bubbles (poke with the end of a brush), slight color variation, and visible texture are what make this convincing.

Drying time: 10-18 hours total

Crema Marfil

13

Easy

1.5-2 hours active

Warm ivory marble

Spain's most popular marble — a warm ivory base with subtle cream and light brown veining. Elegant without being dramatic. A versatile, easy-to-sell effect for living rooms and lobbies.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg

Yellow ochre pigment — 10 ml

Raw umber pigment — 5 ml

Warm ivory base paint — 500 ml

Sandpaper 400 grit

Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of warm ivory base paint.
2. Mix veins: putty + raw umber + small amount of yellow ochre for subtle warm brown veins.
3. Apply gentle, flowing veins — Crema Marfil veins are soft and understated.
4. Create some areas of slightly deeper warmth by lightly troweling the vein mixture in broad patches.
5. Burnish gently for a soft, warm finish.
6. Dry 6+ hours. Sand lightly. Apply satin sealer.

Pro Tip: This is the "safe choice" marble — it goes with everything. When a client can't decide, suggest Crema Marfil. It never clashes with furniture or decor.

Drying time: 12-20 hours total

Medium

2-3 hours active

Ultra-luxury finish

Deep black base with bold golden veining. This isn't a natural marble — it's inspired by Sahara Noir and Port Laurent but amplified for maximum luxury impact. Think five-star hotel lobbies.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 2 kg

Black pigment — 25 ml

Gold metallic pigment — 15 ml

Yellow ochre pigment — 8 ml

Black base paint — 500 ml

Sandpaper 400 grit

Gloss sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of jet black base paint. Must be perfectly opaque.
2. Mix golden vein mixture: putty + gold metallic pigment + yellow ochre. It should shimmer.
3. Apply bold, dramatic golden veins across the black surface. Use confident, sweeping strokes.
4. Add finer secondary gold veins branching from the main ones.
5. Burnish the veins firmly — the metallic pigment will develop more sheen under pressure.
6. Dry 8+ hours. Sand very lightly — don't dull the metallic sheen.
7. Apply gloss sealer — two coats for maximum depth and reflection.

Pro Tip: Less is more with gold veins. A few bold strokes on a vast black field look luxurious; too many veins look busy. Leave at least 60% of the black base visible.

Drying time: 14-24 hours total

Medium

2-2.5 hours active

Complex veined Italian marble

White marble with a complex network of grey and sometimes brown veins creating an almost abstract artistic pattern. More veined than Carrara, less bold than Calacatta.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg

Black pigment — 8 ml

Raw umber pigment — 5 ml

Burnt sienna pigment — 3 ml

White base paint — 500 ml

Sandpaper 400 grit

Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of pure white base paint.
2. Mix grey veins: putty + black + raw umber.
3. Mix warm accent: putty + burnt sienna + raw umber.
4. Create a dense network of interconnected grey veins — Arabescato has more veins than Carrara. They should form irregular closed shapes, like a cracked surface.
5. Add touches of the warm accent within some of the vein intersections.
6. Burnish and blend to soften edges while maintaining the complex pattern.
7. Dry 6+ hours. Sand. Apply satin sealer.

Pro Tip: Think of Arabescato as "organized chaos." The veins form a web, but they flow in a general diagonal direction. Study real Arabescato photos for the right density.

Drying time: 12-24 hours total

Medium

2-3 hours active

Crystalline natural stone

A metamorphic stone with a subtle sparkle and organic flowing patterns. Quartzite is trending heavily in interior design as an alternative to marble — clients love it.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg

Pearl/mica pigment — 10 ml

Grey pigment — 8 ml

Raw umber pigment — 3 ml

Off-white base paint — 500 ml

Sandpaper 400 grit

Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of off-white base paint.
2. Mix the main body: putty + pearl/mica pigment for a subtle shimmer.
3. Mix veins: putty + grey + raw umber.
4. Apply the pearlescent body mix across the entire surface in broad, sweeping strokes.
5. Add grey veins with a flowing, organic quality — quartzite veins look like frozen water movement.
6. Burnish firmly — the mica particles will catch the light beautifully when polished.
7. Dry 6+ hours. Sand gently. Apply satin sealer.

Pro Tip: The pearl/mica pigment is the secret ingredient. It makes the surface shimmer subtly when light hits it at different angles, just like real quartzite.

Drying time: 12-24 hours total

Epoxy Resin Marble

Advanced

3-5 hours active

High-gloss resin technique

A completely different technique using epoxy resin instead of acrylic putty. Creates an ultra-high-gloss, depth-rich marble effect. Best for countertops, tabletops, and smaller feature areas.

MATERIALS

Clear epoxy resin kit — 2 L	White epoxy pigment — 20 ml
Grey epoxy pigment — 10 ml	Metallic gold pigment — 5 ml
Heat gun or torch	Mixing cups and stir sticks
White primer spray — 1 can	

STEPS

1. Prepare the surface: clean, level, and sealed. Apply white primer and let dry.
2. Mix epoxy resin according to manufacturer instructions. Divide into three cups.
3. Tint cup 1 with white pigment (the main body), cup 2 with grey (veins), cup 3 with metallic gold (accents).
4. Pour the white mixture over the surface, spreading evenly with a trowel or spreader.
5. Drizzle the grey mixture in vein patterns. Then add small amounts of gold along the grey veins.
6. Use a heat gun held 15-20cm above the surface to pop air bubbles and slightly blend the colors. Move continuously — never hold in one spot.
7. Use a thin stick or skewer to draw through the veins, creating organic movement.
8. Allow to self-level and cure for 24-48 hours in a dust-free environment.

Pro Tip: Temperature matters with epoxy. Work in 20-25°C environments. Too cold and it won't flow; too hot and it cures too fast. And always, always calculate 20% more resin than you think you need.

Curing time: 24-72 hours (varies by product)

Thunder Grey

18

Easy

1.5-2 hours active

Contemporary grey stone

A modern grey marble with dramatic dark and light contrast. Inspired by Bardiglio and Pietra Grigia — the go-to choice for contemporary, minimalist interiors.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg

Black pigment — 15 ml

White pigment — 10 ml

Medium grey base paint — 500 ml

Sandpaper 400 grit

Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of medium grey base paint.
2. Mix two shades: (A) dark grey — putty + black; (B) light grey — putty + white.
3. Apply dramatic streaks of both dark and light grey across the surface, creating strong tonal contrast.
4. Blend where the two tones meet, but leave areas of sharp contrast.
5. Add thin white veins cutting through the darker areas.
6. Burnish firmly. Dry 6+ hours. Sand. Apply satin sealer.

Pro Tip: Work in long, confident strokes — this effect is about drama and movement, not subtle blending.

Drying time: 12-20 hours total

Medium

2-2.5 hours active

North African warm marble

A rich golden-beige marble from North Africa with warm honey tones and subtle veining. Perfect for creating warm, inviting spaces with a touch of exotic luxury.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg

Yellow ochre pigment — 15 ml

Burnt sienna pigment — 8 ml

Raw umber pigment — 5 ml

Gold/honey base paint — 500 ml

Sandpaper 400 grit

Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of warm honey/gold base paint.
2. Mix three shades of gold-to-brown using yellow ochre, burnt sienna, and raw umber in different proportions.
3. Apply in flowing, layered strokes creating warm tonal variation across the surface.
4. Add subtle darker veins using the deepest mixture.
5. Burnish for a warm, polished glow. Dry 6+ hours. Sand. Apply satin sealer.

Pro Tip: This effect relies on warmth. Avoid adding any cool tones (black, grey, blue). Keep everything in the yellow-brown family.

Drying time: 12-24 hours total

Arctic White Quartz

20

Easy

1-1.5 hours active

Clean modern white

The cleanest, whitest stone finish — minimal veining, maximum brightness. Inspired by engineered quartz countertops. Perfect for kitchens, bathrooms, and modern minimalist spaces.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 2 kg

Black pigment — 2 ml

Pearl/mica pigment — 5 ml

White base paint — 500 ml

Sandpaper 400 grit

Matte sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of pure white base paint.
2. Mix the body: putty + pearl pigment for a subtle sparkle.
3. Apply across the entire surface in smooth, even passes.
4. Mix a barely-there grey: putty + tiny amount of black.
5. Add extremely subtle veins — barely visible whispers of grey. Less is more.
6. Burnish smooth. Dry 4+ hours. Sand. Apply matte sealer for a clean modern look.

Pro Tip: This effect is about restraint. The surface should look almost pure white, with veining only visible when you look closely. The pearl shimmer does the heavy lifting.

Drying time: 10-18 hours total

Easy

1.5-2 hours active

Tuscan villa plaster

A warm, aged Italian plaster finish reminiscent of old Tuscan villas. Subtle variation in warm earth tones creates a lived-in, elegant atmosphere.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 3 kg

Yellow ochre pigment — 12 ml

Red oxide pigment — 5 ml

Raw umber pigment — 5 ml

Warm terra base paint — 500 ml

Sandpaper 320 grit

Wax sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of warm terracotta-tinted base paint.
2. Mix a warm body color: putty + yellow ochre + red oxide for a Tuscan terracotta.
3. Apply in overlapping, irregular trowel strokes. Leave texture — this finish should feel hand-crafted.
4. Add variation using slightly lighter and darker versions of the same color family.
5. Burnish selectively — polish some areas smooth while leaving others textured for an aged effect.
6. Dry 8+ hours. Sand lightly. Apply wax for a warm, natural patina.

Pro Tip: The beauty of this finish is its imperfection. Think of walls you've seen in old Italian farmhouses — uneven, weathered, but full of character.

Drying time: 14-24 hours total

Rosso Levanto

22

Medium

2-2.5 hours active

Deep red Italian marble

A deep, dramatic burgundy-red marble with white and cream veining. Bold and opulent — used in the grandest European palaces and cathedrals.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg

Red oxide pigment — 15 ml

Black pigment — 10 ml

White pigment — 12 ml

Raw umber pigment — 5 ml

Deep burgundy base paint — 500 ml

Sandpaper 400 grit

Gloss sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of deep burgundy base paint.
2. Mix body: putty + red oxide + black for a rich, deep red-brown.
3. Apply textured patches of the body color across the wall.
4. Mix white veins: putty + white pigment + touch of raw umber for slightly warm white veins.
5. Apply dramatic white veins cutting through the dark red surface.
6. Burnish firmly for a polished, regal look. Dry 8+ hours. Sand. Apply gloss sealer.

Pro Tip: This effect makes a powerful statement — use it on one accent wall, not all four. A full room of Rosso Levanto can feel overwhelming.

Drying time: 14-24 hours total

Medium

2-2.5 hours active

Cool-toned modern marble

A contemporary cool-toned marble with flowing silver-grey waves. Clean, sophisticated, and modern — perfect for bathrooms, offices, and contemporary living spaces.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg

Black pigment — 10 ml

Silver metallic pigment — 8 ml

White pigment — 10 ml

Pale grey base paint — 500 ml

Sandpaper 400 grit

Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of very pale grey base paint.
2. Mix wave mix: putty + black + silver metallic pigment for shimmering grey waves.
3. Apply in long, horizontal flowing strokes creating wave-like movement across the wall.
4. Add brighter silver highlights using putty + silver + white.
5. Burnish in the direction of the waves. Dry 6+ hours. Sand. Apply satin sealer.

Pro Tip: The waves should all flow in the same general horizontal direction but at slightly varying angles — like ocean waves approaching shore.

Drying time: 12-20 hours total

Medium

2-2.5 hours active

Dark grey Persian marble

A dark grey marble from Iran with fine white linear veining. One of the most sought-after natural stones in modern architecture. Clean, architectural, and masculine.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg

Black pigment — 18 ml

White pigment — 12 ml

Raw umber pigment — 3 ml

Dark grey base paint — 500 ml

Sandpaper 400 grit

Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of dark charcoal grey base paint.
2. Mix dark body: putty + black + touch of raw umber.
3. Apply a thin, slightly varied body layer across the surface.
4. Mix white veins: putty + white pigment for bright, clean white lines.
5. Create thin, straight, parallel veins — Pietra Grey's veins are linear and architectural, not flowing or organic.
6. Burnish firmly. Dry 6+ hours. Sand. Apply satin sealer.

Pro Tip: Pietra Grey veins are remarkably linear — almost like ruled lines on a page. This makes it one of the easier "advanced-looking" effects to execute. Use a straightedge to guide your spatula if needed.

Drying time: 12-24 hours total

Botticino Beige

25

Easy

1.5 hours active

Classic warm marble

A classic warm beige marble from Italy. Neutral, versatile, and timeless. The safe choice that always looks good and matches any interior style.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg

Yellow ochre pigment — 8 ml

Raw umber pigment — 5 ml

Warm beige base paint — 500 ml

Sandpaper 400 grit

Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of warm beige base paint.
2. Mix subtle veins: putty + raw umber for soft, barely-there veining.
3. Apply gentle veins across the surface — Botticino is understated.
4. Burnish for a smooth, warm finish. Dry 6+ hours. Sand. Apply satin sealer.

Pro Tip: Like Crema Marfil, Botticino is a crowd-pleaser. The difference is Botticino is cooler and more neutral. Choose Crema Marfil for warm spaces, Botticino for neutral ones.

Drying time: 10-18 hours total

Midnight Blue Stone

26

Medium

2-3 hours active

Deep blue natural stone

A dark, mysterious blue stone finish with subtle lighter inclusions. Less exotic than Sodalite, more accessible — great for powder rooms, ceilings, and media rooms.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg

Ultramarine blue pigment — 15 ml

Black pigment — 10 ml

White pigment — 8 ml

Dark navy base paint — 500 ml

Sandpaper 400 grit

Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of dark navy base paint.
2. Mix body: putty + ultramarine + black for a deep midnight blue.
3. Apply in textured, layered strokes across the surface.
4. Add subtle lighter areas using putty + ultramarine + white.
5. Create very fine veins with the lighter mix.
6. Burnish firmly. Dry 6+ hours. Sand. Apply satin sealer.

Pro Tip: Keep it dark and moody. The beauty of this effect is its depth — don't make the light areas too bright or too frequent.

Drying time: 12-24 hours total

Terracotta Rustic

27

Easy

1.5-2 hours active

Mediterranean warmth

A warm, textured terracotta finish reminiscent of Mediterranean walls. Organic, earthy, and inviting. Popular for kitchens, patios, and Mediterranean-style interiors.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 3 kg

Red oxide pigment — 15 ml

Yellow ochre pigment — 10 ml

Raw umber pigment — 5 ml

Terracotta base paint — 500 ml

Sandpaper 220-320 grit

Matte sealer or wax — 200 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of terracotta base paint.
2. Mix warm terracotta body: putty + red oxide + yellow ochre. Create two or three slightly different shades.
3. Apply in rough, irregular patches. Leave plenty of texture and trowel marks — this should look hand-plastered, not machine-smooth.
4. While wet, scratch or scrape lightly in places to reveal the base coat for an aged, weathered look.
5. Dry 8+ hours. Sand irregularly — more in some spots than others to enhance the aged feel.
6. Apply matte sealer or wax for a natural, earthy finish.

Pro Tip: Imperfection is the goal. The more handmade it looks, the more authentic it feels. Don't try to make it uniform.

Drying time: 14-24 hours total

Easy

1.5 hours active

Pearlescent finish

A soft, luminous finish that catches the light with a subtle mother-of-pearl shimmer. Elegant and understated — popular for bedrooms, bridal suites, and high-end retail.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg

Pearl/mica pigment — 15 ml

White pigment — 5 ml

Off-white base paint — 500 ml

Sandpaper 400 grit

Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of off-white base paint.
2. Mix body: putty + pearl/mica pigment + white pigment for a luminous, pearlescent mixture.
3. Apply in smooth, overlapping trowel strokes across the entire surface.
4. Create subtle movement by varying the direction of your strokes — the mica particles will catch light differently from each angle.
5. Burnish firmly to develop maximum sheen. Dry 4+ hours. Sand very lightly. Apply satin sealer.

Pro Tip: This effect shines most with directional lighting — a wall sconce or recessed spotlight will make the pearl shimmer dance beautifully.

Drying time: 10-18 hours total

Easy

1.5-2 hours active

Volcanic texture

A rugged, textured volcanic stone finish. Dark, dramatic, and masculine. Great for bars, game rooms, wine cellars, and industrial-chic spaces.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 3 kg

Black pigment — 20 ml

Raw umber pigment — 8 ml

Charcoal base paint — 500 ml

Sandpaper 220-320 grit

Matte sealer — 250 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of charcoal base paint.
2. Mix dark body: putty + black + raw umber.
3. Apply in thick, rough patches. Use the trowel edge to create pitted, volcanic texture — press and lift, press and lift.
4. Leave the surface rough and uneven — lava stone is never smooth.
5. Let dry 8+ hours. Sand the high points only, leaving the pits rough.
6. Apply matte sealer — never gloss for lava stone.

Pro Tip: Create the volcanic pits by dabbing the surface with a crumpled paper towel while the putty is still wet, then partially smoothing the high points.

Drying time: 14-24 hours total

Easy

1.5-2 hours active

Oxidized metal effect

A weathered, oxidized metal look combining rusty oranges, verdigris greens, and aged copper tones. Not stone, but a popular complementary effect for industrial and artistic spaces.

MATERIALS

White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg	Red oxide pigment — 15 ml
Burnt sienna pigment — 10 ml	Chrome green pigment — 8 ml
Black pigment — 5 ml	Dark brown base paint — 500 ml
Sandpaper 320 grit	Matte sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

1. Apply two coats of dark brown/rust base paint.
2. Mix three colors: (A) rust — putty + red oxide + burnt sienna; (B) oxidized green — putty + chrome green; (C) aged dark — putty + black + raw umber.
3. Apply mixture A as the primary color in irregular patches.
4. Add mixture B in spots and streaks where oxidation would naturally occur — corners, edges, areas where moisture would collect.
5. Use mixture C to create shadow and depth in the transitions.
6. Blend loosely — the colors should transition naturally, not be sharply divided.
7. Dry 6+ hours. Sand selectively. Apply matte sealer.

Pro Tip: Study real oxidized copper or rusted steel for color placement. Water flows down and collects in crevices — that's where the green oxidation appears. The logic of real weathering makes the effect convincing.

Drying time: 12-20 hours total

Bonus Blends & Troubleshooting



CUSTOM BLENDING TECHNIQUES

Once you've mastered individual recipes, try combining them:

- **Calacatta + Gold Metallic** — Add metallic gold pigment to the Calacatta vein mix for a glamorous twist.
- **Carrara + Warm Tint** — Add a tiny amount of yellow ochre to the Carrara base for a warmer, antique look.
- **Nero Marquina + Emperador** — Create the dark body of Nero Marquina but add warm brown veins alongside the white ones.
- **Travertine + Venetian Stucco** — Apply Venetian technique but with travertine colors and deliberate pitting.
- **Concrete + Metallic** — Add silver or copper metallic pigment to the concrete mix for an industrial-luxe hybrid.

COMMON PROBLEMS & SOLUTIONS

- **Veins look too thick** — Use less material on the spatula edge. Wipe excess off before applying. Practice on a sample board first.
- **Colors look muddy** — You're over-blending. Apply with confidence and blend minimally. Each layer should be distinguishable.
- **Surface cracking** — Layers are too thick. Apply multiple thin layers instead of one thick one. Each layer should be 0.5-1mm max.
- **Uneven sheen after sealing** — Sand more evenly before sealing. Apply sealer in uniform, thin coats. Use a fresh roller or brush.
- **Putty drying too fast** — Mist the wall lightly with water. Work in smaller sections. Add a retarder to your putty mix (1-2% by volume).
- **Colors don't match the reference photo** — Pigment concentration varies by brand. Always test your mix on a sample board before the wall. Photograph both the reference and your test under the same light.

MAINTENANCE

Properly sealed marble effects are durable and easy to maintain:

- Wipe with a damp microfiber cloth for regular cleaning.
- Avoid abrasive cleaners or scrubbing — they can dull the sealer.
- Reapply sealer every 2-3 years for high-traffic areas, or whenever water stops beading on the surface.

- For wax-sealed finishes, reapply wax annually with a lint-free cloth and buff.
- Minor scuffs can be repaired with a small amount of matching putty, blended and resealed.